

self-taught by the machine or trained by the user. By eliminating the manual interaction of a user towards these tasks more time will be freed up for a productive lifestyle. By monitoring the habits and needs of the user, all the home systems will learn how to align their different functions. For example, if the house intelligence observes that the user has forgotten to turn off the lights it can do it to save energy, even motion detected lights are an option in case of intruders and remote cell phone monitoring of the house by the user are the most basic features.

One of the most critical areas where home automation can prove invaluable is security. An intelligent home fitted with sensors on the Internet of Things can almost work as a fortress. By incorporating the sensors in the doors and windows, along with security cameras outside the house supported by motion detecting lights, the house can spot intruders quickly. As the house gathers the data and senses a threat it can even be programmed to alert the user if they are not at home or unaware, and even communicate with the police to ask for assistance. This level of security is supported by a great degree of surveillance which is currently accomplished using simple webcams. But with enhanced sensors come enhanced cameras which can even be used for facial recognition and advanced alerts as to the identity of the threat. This can help avoid over reactions or embarrassments since the system can recognise a familiar face from a stranger. The level of security also reaches to safety from hazards like fire and smoke, which is accomplished by gas detectors. They can warn users of any building issues and give enough notice for everyone to get to safety.

Intelligent home designs today and the future

Intelligent homes haven't been around for a long time, but the idea of a smart home has been around for nearly a century. The early era of science fiction looked towards a future where the whole world was a utopia of technology. Many of the concepts introduced during this period have gone on to inspire modern creations. The most reality driven models were however during the mid-20th century and were often claimed to be the "Homes of Tomorrow" where automation played a large role in daily activities. And as the computer age dawned, the inclusion of a "mechanical brain" serving mankind became all the more apparent. But the real creation of the intelligent household came with a Scottish Company in 1975, called Pico Electronics who began the X10 project. The X10 project was the first home automation project that used electrical wiring to operate.